

WhatsApp Booking — What We Need From You

Customers will be able to book an appointment entirely inside WhatsApp — no app, no website — by replying to numbered prompts (e.g. "1. Dog, 2. Cat"). The booking, pricing, availability and payment logic is already built and reuses the exact same engine as the website. To turn it on, we need a few things from Meta (WhatsApp's owner) that only you can provide, since they require your business's own accounts.

What to set up, in order

Step	Where	What to do
1. Business account	business.facebook.com	Create or log into your Meta Business Suite account for the company.
2. Developer app	developers.facebook.com	Create a new app, choose "Business" type, then add the WhatsApp product to it.
3. Phone number	App → WhatsApp → API Setup	Either use Meta's free test number to try things out first, or add your real business number. Important: a number added here can no longer be used in the regular WhatsApp / WhatsApp Business phone app at the same time.
4. Permanent access token	App → Business Settings → Users → System Users	Create a System User, generate a permanent token for it with <code>whatsapp_business_messaging</code> permission. (The temporary token shown on the API Setup page expires in 24 hours — don't send us that one.)
5. App Secret	App → App Settings → Basic	Copy the "App Secret" value (click "Show").

Send us

- **Phone Number ID** (from step 3 — a long number, not the phone number itself)
- **Permanent access token** (from step 4)
- **App Secret** (from step 5)
- The **real phone number** you want customers texting for bookings

Send these via a password manager or secure share — not plain email/chat.

What happens after that

We'll add your values to the site, give you a webhook URL and a verify code to paste back into the Meta App Dashboard (**WhatsApp** → **Configuration** → **Webhook**), and test the full booking flow end-to-end before it goes live for customers.

Good to know

- **Business verification:** to message more than a handful of test numbers, Meta requires verifying your business — this can take a few business days, so it's worth starting early rather than at launch.
- **Cost:** Meta gives a free monthly allowance of conversations, then charges per conversation after that — check current pricing at business.whatsapp.com before launch.
- **24-hour reply window:** this only affects free-form replies more than 24 hours after a customer's last message (e.g. a reminder) — it doesn't affect the booking flow itself, which is always customer-initiated.